AKANKSHA PANDEY

Product Designer | FinTech | Growth & Consumer UX

Gurugram, India | akankshapandeyy04@gmail.com | +91 8707524462 | Portfolio | LinkedIn

SUMMARY

Product Designer with 1.5+ years of end-to-end product design in B2C FinTech, specialising in growth design: onboarding, activation, conversion, subscriptions and referrals. Data-driven, user-centered designer who lifted 5-minute activation by 20% and designed a referral program driving about 30% of user acquisition. Skilled in user research, interaction and visual design, prototyping in Figma, and cross-functional collaboration in a regulated environment.

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer (promoted from Design Intern) | Returns Wealth, algo investing platform for retail investors | May 2025 – Present

- **Redesigned algo discovery** with personalized filters, search and improved algo cards, increasing activation within the first 5 minutes by 20% Designed a 60-second onboarding flow that simplifies a first-of-its-kind retail algo trading product, building user trust and guiding users from sign-up to activation. Owned end-to-end subscription and multi-stage upgrade journeys, personalised by user segment (ICP), plan state and lifecycle stages to improve conversion.
- **Designed the referral program end to end**, from user research and user flows to wireframes, high-fidelity UI, prototyping and developer handoff; referrals contribute about 30% of user acquisition.
- **Designed segmented lifecycle communication** (in-app, WhatsApp, Telegram) and story-led financial education that explains algo trading, futures and intraday to retail investors [add: engagement metric]. Collaborated with product managers, engineers and compliance to balance user needs, business KPIs and regulatory requirements.
- Built reusable components in the Figma design system & Defined the app's visual style and art direction, a hyperrealism- and surrealism-inspired visual language that made the product distinctive and visually appealing.

Design Research & Strategy Intern | Indriya (Aditya Birla Group) | Jan 2024 – Jun 2024
Conducted field user research across Bihar, West Bengal and Gujarat on customer preferences and retail behaviour, and synthesised insights into market-specific collections launched in Bihar and Gujarat.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Design (B.Des), Fashion & Lifestyle Accessory Design | National Institute of Fashion Technology (NIFT), Kolkata | 2024

SKILLS

Product Design: UX Design, UI Design, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Wireframing, Prototyping, Information Architecture, User Journey Mapping, User Flows, Developer Handoff

Research & Growth: User Research, Growth Design, Onboarding, Activation, Conversion Optimization, Retention, Referral Programs

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Notion, Procreate, Procreate Dreams

Design Systems, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Behavioral Analytics, Mobile App Design (iOS/Android), Accessibility (WCAG), Jira, Framer, AI Prototyping (Figma Make, Lovable, v0)

Domain: FinTech, Investing, Algo Trading, B2C Consumer Apps, Regulated Products